

Public overview of Article 15 EU Digital Markets Act (EU DMA) report

Public overview of the Article 15 EU Digital Markets Act (EU DMA) report for services provided by Core Platform Services in the European Union on 1 January 2024.

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General introduction to the public overviews

On 6 September 2023, the European Commission designated Alphabet Inc. (“Alphabet”) as a gatekeeper pursuant to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA) and designated the following Alphabet services as Core Platform Services (“CPS”) within the meaning of Art. 3(1) (b) DMA: Google Ads CPS, Google Android CPS, Google Chrome CPS, Google Maps CPS, Google Play CPS, Google Search CPS, Google Shopping CPS and YouTube CPS.

Art. 15 DMA requires Alphabet as a gatekeeper to submit to the European Commission an independently audited description of any techniques for profiling of consumers that the gatekeeper applies to or across its CPSs listed in the designation decision and to make publicly available an overview of the audited description. This document contains the public, non-confidential overview of the audited description¹. For example, profiling techniques may be used to personalise users’ experiences (including to recommend the most relevant content), to protect users and to prevent fraud and abuse on our services.

The information in this document is provided only for the purposes of meeting regulatory obligations under Art. 15 DMA to annually publish an overview on profiling techniques utilised by Alphabet’s CPSs in the European Union. This report covers profiling of consumers applied by Alphabet to or across its CPSs on 1 January 2024 and does not cover subsequent changes to Google systems and user controls, including those required by the DMA which come into effect on 6 March 2024. This document will be updated annually.

We continue to invest in easy-to-use controls and settings that help users manage the data they have shared with Google, including tools such as [Privacy Checkup](#), [My Activity](#), [Google Account](#) and [My Ad Center](#). We are transparent about what data we collect and why, so we make this information easy to find and understand, and we keep our [Privacy Policy](#) up to date, including videos to support users’ understanding of how we use data. More information about how we collect and use data is also provided on the following sites: [Privacy Principles](#), [EU user consent policy](#), [About privacy and personalised ads](#).

¹ The Google Android CPS does not engage in profiling of consumers. As such, this overview does not contain a section on the Google Android CPS.

1) Profiling Techniques of Users - Google Ads CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and Google Ads as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). Google Ads provides several online advertising tools or services offered to advertisers, publishers and advertising intermediation services providers. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the Google Ads CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. If any consumer facing product or feature within the Google Ads CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing consumers with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, (h) how we seek user consent, and (i) how we seek user consent through third parties, and links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. In some cases, Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The Google Ads CPS further ensures a high level of transparency for users through additional measures. Google requires the clear labelling of ads and sponsored content to distinguish it from organic content, and provides in-ad disclosures to make it easy for users to understand why specific ads are shown, what information is used and how users can control their Google ad experience.

For example, [My Ad Center](#) shows users disclosures about the information that influences the ads they see and makes it easy to manage that information based on their preference. My Ad Center allows users to customise their ad experiences to see more of the brands and topics they like and less of the ones

they do not like. Users can also choose to limit ads about certain sensitive ad topics, including alcohol, dating, gambling, pregnancy and parenting, and weight loss. Users can turn off ads personalisation altogether and also permanently delete the activity data saved to their account at any time with the data and privacy settings. Users are further notified through dedicated advertising technology [disclosures](#), the [Google Safety Center](#) and in [My Ad Center](#).

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as the Personalised Ads setting to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the Google Ads CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The Google Ads CPS, as defined by the European Commission, uses profiling to provide more relevant and helpful ads as well as for fraud detection and counter-abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes.

For the personalisation of ads, profiling helps the Google Ads CPS to show users ads that are more relevant to their interests, and improve the overall quality of ads served. To help protect users, customers and the wider online community, and keep the internet helpful and safer for all, the Google Ads CPS carefully analyses information, including through profiling, to identify and stop fraud, spam and other harmful online activities. Finally, the Google Ads CPS uses certain profiling techniques for compliance and legal purposes. For instance, this helps to determine if a user is a minor so that we can implement safeguards for minors where required by law. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, Google Ads CPS uses various machine learning classifications, clustering methods, recommender/ranking systems, and regressions.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Ads as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the Google Ads CPS's services. It also requires information about data processed for fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Ads CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the Google Ads CPS:

- **Personal information users provide to Google services:** This includes settings made by the user for Google Ads Personalisation and user survey data. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google Services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services. The level of granularity of the location data depends, in particular, on the relevant profiling purpose. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Other information from our trusted partners:** This includes information about users from Google's third party trusted partners, e.g., information provided by Google's marketing partners, security partners, and advertising partners. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Ads as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for Google Ads CPS's services. It also requires information about data inferred for fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Ads CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Demographics:** This includes a user's demographics such as gender or age. Demographics may be used, for example, to protect minors in line with legal obligations or to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Attributes:** Attributes include general, non-sensitive interests and affinities of users that can be inferred, such as interests in coffee shops or restaurants. These may be used, for example, to

improve the relevance of a user's experience and advertisements shown to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Location:** This category includes inferred user location information. Location information may be used, for example, to enforce legal and regulatory restrictions, and to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to provide more relevant and comprehensible content in the language of the user. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include ranking and providing more relevant content, offers and/or advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Statistical inferences about user interactions:** These inferences may be used to detect invalid traffic and to provide more relevant advertisements to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Data for anti-abuse purposes:** Data for anti-abuse purposes includes inferences about the likelihood that certain requests are coming from invalid traffic and other information to identify harmful or unlawful content. This data may be used, for example, to protect our users, customers, the general public and Google's systems against fraud and abuse. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Ads CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h), and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The Google Ads CPS utilises profiling techniques to show relevant ads to users, to detect and prevent fraud and abuse, as well as for general legal and compliance purposes. This is important for the Google Ads CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

- The Google Ads CPS provides users with more relevant and helpful advertisements, as well as to better match ads to the user's (main) language. This also helps advertisers to tailor their advertising messages to resonate with specific groups.
- The Google Ads CPS also employs user profiling techniques to determine if an interaction with an ad is [invalid](#). This helps Google to combat a number of different forms of fraud, such as false representation of domains, "clickjacking" (a web attack where the appearance of a website is changed so that a user does not realise they are clicking on an ad) and fake traffic that originates from computers infected with malware (so-called "botnets"). For example, Google was able to help take down the [major online fraud operation](#) called "3ve" which generated billions of fraudulent ad bid requests (i.e., ad spaces on web pages that advertisers can bid to purchase in an automated way) which led to the dismantling of two international cybercriminal rings.

Some profiling activities for certain, narrowly defined, or legally required purposes, especially for fraud and abuse detection, may be applied to all our users. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The Google Ads CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the Google Ads CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (a) GDPR to provide personalised services, including the provision of personalised ads. To protect the Google Ads CPS, our users, and the public, the Google Ads CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (c) and (f) GDPR. This includes processing for the purpose of fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as compliance and legal purposes, law enforcement requests and incident management.

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for Google Ads CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

Google uses the Personalised Ads setting to seek consent from signed-in users for certain forms of personalisation that are relevant for the Google Ads CPS and may involve profiling. Users are asked to make a choice about the Personalised Ads setting, as well as other settings, during the Google account creation process. For consents obtained through third parties (including for signed-out users), please see section (i).

Account Creation Process

Users are asked if they would like to consent to the forms of personalisation controlled by the settings presented during the account creation process. Google offers two paths during account creation, an “Express” path that allows the user to make choices about multiple settings in a single step, and a “Manual” path that allows users to make a choice about each setting on a different screen. Users are able to go back to prior screens and switch between these paths during the account creation process. In both paths, users are presented with information about: (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

During the “Express” and “Manual” paths, users are informed that they can change their settings and withdraw their consent by visiting account.google.com after they have created their account. A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Personalised Ads setting by turning the setting off at any time.

Users who want to turn the Ads Personalisation setting on after account creation are presented with the same substantive information that is presented during account creation about (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consent described above will not receive the forms of personalisation that are controlled by this consent.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

Google requires third parties who use Google Ads services to ensure user consent is obtained for the use of cookies or other local storage where legally required and for the collection, sharing, and use of personal data with Google for ads personalisation purposes. Third parties that must ensure user consent is obtained include publishers, advertisers, data management platforms and third party exchanges.

Means by which a third party may collect user consent

Third parties must use a valid means to obtain user consent and may use an in-house solution or a Consent Management Platform. In any event, the solution used must comply with local regulations and Google’s policies including our [Consent Policy](#) for the EU. To support our customers, we provide [guidance](#) on how to comply with this policy and how Google validates compliance.

How a user can withdraw consent

Users must be able to revoke their consent through the consent flows provided by third parties. Our Consent Policy for the EU requires that users are informed about how they can do so. At a minimum, users must be able to easily reach their consent settings on the respective site or app.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The Google Ads CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

l) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work. Examples for such potential alternatives are provided below:

- **Age assurance:** For age assurance, profiling allows us to infer the user's age in a minimally intrusive manner. As an alternative, users could be asked to provide and prove their age with legal documentation, which would have to be verified, and users verified as adults would have to remain signed-in at all times to benefit from all of Google's services. While some users may prove their age for instance with government IDs, this alternative is generally not preferred as not all users have access to government issued identification or would wish to provide it.
- **Fraud and abuse:** For the detection of fraud and abuse in the context of advertisements, advertisers could rely on their own human review instead of profiling by Google. This would risk detecting less invalid activity or bad actors, as it would leave fraud and abuse detection up to varying levels of technology and capabilities of individual advertisers and potentially other third party companies. The scale, speed, and diversity of attempts to attack and abuse our advertising network require sophisticated automated detection and significant expertise to keep a safe advertising environment for users and prevent attempts to defraud advertisers through various types of invalid activity. Also, effective fraud and abuse detection outsourced to third parties would very likely involve similar profiling techniques as the ones used by Google. The use of these third parties, with varying degrees of capabilities and expertise, would impose

unnecessary financial burden on advertisers, while increasing the potential for fragmentation in the approach, classification, and mitigation of invalid activity.

2) Profiling Techniques of Users - Google Chrome CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and Google Chrome as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). Google Chrome is used by users and customers for the same purpose irrespective of the device on which it is provided, namely, to offer, access and interact with content displayed on websites. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the Google Chrome CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. If any consumer facing product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, and (h) how we seek user consent, and links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. In some cases, Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The Google Chrome Ads further ensures a high level of transparency through additional measures. For instance, Google Chrome's [downloading webpage](#) shows users how Google Chrome keeps them safe online.

Users can also see and control their [privacy settings](#), as well as see and control their activity via [My Google Activity](#).

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as Topics API to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the Google Chrome CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The Google Chrome CPS, as defined by the European Commission, conducts user profiling for personalisation of ads via the Topics API Privacy Sandbox², provision of personalised support and personalisation or customisation of products and services³. For Google Chrome's Topics API Privacy Sandbox, this means that coarse-grained advertising topics corresponding to a user's browsing history can be provided to third parties. For personalised support this helps us to provide users with higher quality information and assistance. Profiling is also used to provide the user with a personalised experience of relevant content. For the Google Chrome CPS, this means that services can be provided in the correct language. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, Google Chrome CPS uses various machine learning classifications, recommender/ranking systems, and regressions.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Chrome as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the Google Chrome CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data processed for the personalisation of ads via the Topics API Privacy Sandbox. The Google Chrome CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the Google Chrome CPS:

- **Content users create, upload or receive:** This includes content that users create, upload, or receive when using Google's services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personal information users provide to Google services,** e.g., if a user provides their home or work location. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with

² As part of the Privacy Sandbox initiative, Google Chrome has an option for users to enable an API that provides third parties with coarse-grained advertising topics that correspond to a user's browsing history. These coarse-grained topics are a data-minimising alternative to more identifiable forms of personalisation for ads purposes. Google Chrome does not apply this profiling mechanism to its provision of browser services nor does it personalise ads in its product. This is the only profiling for the purpose of ads personalisation conducted by Google Chrome.

³ Google Chrome processes language to customise a user's Google Chrome experience. Google Chrome does not apply profiling mechanisms to its provision of browser services nor does it personalise ads in its product.

transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google Services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services. The level of granularity of the location data depends, in particular, on the relevant profiling purpose. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Chrome as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for Google Chrome CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data inferred for the personalisation of ads via the Topics API Privacy Sandbox. The Google Chrome CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to help users set up their browsers in the right language and to make smarter translation suggestions. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include ranking and providing more relevant content, search query results, offers and/or advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Chrome CPS. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The Google Chrome CPS utilises profiling techniques to personalise and/or customise products and services, provide personalised support, and to provide coarse-grained advertising topics corresponding to a user's browsing history. This is important for the Google Chrome CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

- The Google Chrome CPS employs user profiling techniques to provide personalised support to users using the Google Chrome CPS's products and services. Such personalised support is generally more tailored to the user's needs, allowing for faster access to relevant product support and increased user satisfaction.

Our services offered to customers may benefit from, among others, profiling activities. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The Google Chrome CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. Data that is not subject to user controls may only be retained ephemerally for profiling uses in general. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the Google Chrome CPS relies on Art. 6(1)(a) and (f) GDPR to enable personalised services, including personalisation and/or customisation of products and services,

the provision of personalised support, and for users to enable the receipt of personalised ads using Topics API Privacy Sandbox (for Topics API Privacy Sandbox we ask for consent).⁴

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for Google Chrome CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

Google seeks consent from users before generating course-grained topics that correspond to a user's browsing history through the Privacy Sandbox initiative identified in section (a) of this CPS overview. In their Privacy and Security settings, users have control over the topics that Chrome shares with third party API callers, such as ad tech providers, through the [Topics API](#). A user can opt out of specific topics and can disable the API in their settings. A user who refuses or withdraws their consent will not have advertising topics generated based on their browsing history.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

This section is not relevant for the Google Chrome CPS as it does not rely on personal data originating from third parties.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The Google Chrome CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

⁴ As part of the Privacy Sandbox initiative, Google Chrome has an option for users to enable an API that provides third parties with coarse-grained advertising topics that correspond to a user's browsing history. These coarse-grained topics are a data-minimising alternative to more identifiable forms of personalisation for ads purposes. Google Chrome does not apply this profiling mechanism to its provision of browser services nor does it personalise ads in its product. This is the only profiling for the purpose of ads personalisation conducted by Google Chrome. As part of the Privacy Sandbox initiative, Chrome creates an API that provides third parties with coarse-grained advertising topics that correspond to a user's browsing history. These coarse-grained topics are a data-minimising alternative to more identifiable forms of personalisation for ads purposes. Chrome does not apply this profiling mechanism to its provision of browser services nor does it personalise ads in its product.

I) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work.

3) Profiling Techniques of Users - Google Maps CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and Google Maps as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). Google Maps is an online-based user map and navigation service which enables users to search for and navigate to local entities and where local entities can provide information to appear on Google Maps. In addition, the European Commission defined the Google Maps CPS to also include advertisements displayed on Google Maps. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the Google Maps CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. If any consumer facing product or feature within the Google Maps CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing consumers with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, (h) how we seek user consent, and (i) how we seek user consent through third parties. Links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. In some cases, Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The Google Maps CPS further ensures a high level of transparency through additional measures. Google requires the clear labelling of ads and sponsored content to distinguish it from organic content, and provides in-ad disclosures to make it easy for users to understand why specific ads are shown, what information is used and how users can control their Google ad experience.

The Google Maps Help Center provides a general overview on [how user data is used](#) and about [privacy in Google Maps](#). Users can access specific Help Center articles to understand [Google Maps consumer information](#), how their [Google Maps Timeline](#) is created or how to [manage their children's Google Maps activity](#).

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as Web & App Activity, the Personalised Ads setting, and Location History to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the Google Maps CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The Google Maps CPS, as defined by the European Commission, conducts user profiling for personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support, fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as for compliance and other legally required purposes. As described above, the European Commission's definition of the Google Maps CPS also includes advertisements displayed on Google Maps; data can be used to improve the overall quality of these ads.

For personalisation and/or customisation of products, services and support, profiling helps the Google Maps CPS to provide the user with a personalised user experience of relevant content and assistance. To help protect users, customers and the wider online community, and keep the internet helpful and safer for all, the Google Maps CPS carefully analyses information to identify and stop fraud, spam and other harmful online activities. Finally, the Google Maps CPS uses certain profiling techniques for compliance and legal purposes. For instance, this helps us to determine if a user is a minor so that we can implement safeguards for minors where required by law. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, Google Maps CPS uses various machine learning classifications, clustering methods, recommender/ranking systems, regressions, and tailored rules.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Maps as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the Google Maps CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data processed for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Maps CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Maps CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the Google Maps CPS:

- **Content users create or upload:** This includes photos and reviews of businesses on Google Maps. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed

to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **User provided information:** This includes information a user provides to Google, like their home or work location. In addition, settings made for Google Ads Personalisation and user survey data fall into this category. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services and their settings. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Other information from our trusted partners:** This includes information about users from Google's third party trusted partners, e.g., information provided by Google's marketing partners, security partners, and advertising partners. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Maps as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for Google Maps' navigation and discovery services. It also requires information about data inferred for other services, including advertisements shown on Google

Maps as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Maps CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include rankings of maps content, search results about places and related ads. These personalised recommendations and rankings may be used, for example, to provide more relevant things on the map the user is looking at, as well as suggestions, responses to queries and advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Attributes:** Attributes include general, non-sensitive interests and affinities of users, such as interests in coffee shops or restaurants. These may be used, for example, to improve the relevance of a user's experience and the advertisements shown to them. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Location:** This category includes inferred user location information. Location information may be used, for example, to show users results for places that are interesting and relevant to them, to enforce legal and regulatory restrictions, and to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to provide more relevant and comprehensible advertisements in the language of the user. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Data for anti-abuse purposes:** Data for anti-abuse purposes includes inferences about the likelihood that certain requests are coming from invalid traffic and other information to identify harmful or unlawful content. This data may be used, for example, to protect our users, customers, the general public and Google's systems against fraud and abuse. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Demographics:** This includes a user's demographics such as gender or age. Demographics may be used, for example, to protect minors in line with legal obligations or to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed

to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Statistical inferences about user interactions:** These inferences may be used to provide more relevant advertisements to users and detect invalid traffic. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Maps CPS, which includes organic maps and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The Google Maps CPS utilises profiling techniques to show relevant places, reviews, interests and ads to users, to detect and prevent fraud and abuse, as well as for general legal and compliance purposes. This is important for the Google Maps CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

Personalisation of user experience

- The Google Maps CPS employs user profiling techniques to personalise the user's experience while using the online-based maps and navigation service by providing the user with relevant information. For example, if a user frequently searches for ramen shops, they may see ramen shops on their map.
- The Google Maps CPS provides users with more relevant and helpful advertisements, as well as to better match ads to the user's (main) language. This also helps advertisers to tailor their advertising messages to resonate with specific groups. For example, if a user frequently searches for fast casual restaurants, they may see an ad for one on Google Maps.
- The Google Maps CPS employs user profiling techniques to provide personalised support to users using Google's products and services. For example, if a user submits feedback to Google Maps through the "Report a problem button", they may see relevant Help Center articles related to their request.

Fraud and abuse detection and general legal purposes

- Google employs user profiling techniques to determine if an interaction with an ad is [invalid](#). This helps Google to combat a number of different forms of fraud, such as false representation of domains, "clickjacking" (a web attack where the appearance of a website is changed so that a user does not realise they are clicking on an ad) and fake traffic that originates from computers infected with malware (so-called "botnets"). For example, Google was able to help take down the [major online fraud operation](#) called "3ve" which generated billions of fraudulent ad bid requests (i.e., ad spaces on web pages that advertisers can bid to purchase in an automated way) which led to the dismantling of two international cybercriminal rings.

Some profiling activities for certain, narrowly defined, or legally required purposes, especially for fraud and abuse detection, may be applied to all our users. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The Google Maps CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview, below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the Google Maps CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (a) and (f) GDPR to provide personalised services, including personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support and personalisation of ads (when ads are personalised, we ask for consent). To protect the Google Maps CPS, our users, and the public, the Google Maps CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (c) and (f) GDPR. This includes processing for the purpose of fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as compliance and legal purposes, law enforcement requests and incident management.

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for Google Maps CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

I. Signed-In Users

Google uses three settings to seek consent from signed-in users for certain forms of personalisation that are relevant for the Google Maps CPS and may involve profiling: i) Web & App Activity; ii) Personalised Ads; and iii) Location History. Users are asked to make a choice about the Web & App Activity and Personalised Ads settings during the Google account creation process. The Location History setting is not part of the account creation process.

Account Creation Process

Users are asked if they would like to consent to the forms of personalisation controlled by the Web & App Activity and Personalised Ads settings during the account creation process. Google offers two paths during account creation, an "Express" path that allows the user to make choices about multiple

settings in a single step, and a “Manual” path that allows users to make a choice about each setting on a different screen. Users are able to go back to prior screens and switch between these paths during the account creation process. In both paths, users are presented with information about: (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

During the “Express” and “Manual” paths, users are informed that they can change their settings and withdraw their consent by visiting account.google.com after they have created their account. Users who visit these controls are able to toggle these settings on or off and delete data subject to the Web & App Activity setting at any time.

A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Web & App Activity setting by turning the setting off and deleting data that has been previously saved to the user’s account pursuant to the setting. Users also have the option to turn the setting off without deleting saved data, which will stop new activity data from being saved to their account pursuant to the setting, but not withdraw consent for personalisation based on existing saved data. A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Personalised Ads setting by turning the setting off at any time.

Users who want to turn these settings on after account creation are presented with the same substantive information that is presented during account creation about (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

Location History

Google Maps relies on the Location History control setting for signed-in users to obtain consent to save their device location to Location History in the user’s account, choose how long such information is retained, and to allow certain forms of personalisation that may involve profiling. This setting is off by default. To turn Location History on or off, a user can visit the “Location History” section of their [Google Account](https://account.google.com). This page is also linked from “Your data in Maps” in Google Maps settings. Users who turn on Location History are able to withdraw their consent for the personalisation that is controlled by the setting at any time, by visiting the Google Account page described above to toggle the Location History setting off and delete data subject to the setting.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation that are controlled by these consents. A user who has set their Web & App Activity setting to off will also not have certain data about their activity saved to their account while the setting is off.

When [Location History is off](#), the user’s devices also do not save their location to Location History in the User’s account. Turning off Location History does not change other location services on the User’s device, or affect the saving of location data by other settings like Web & App Activity.

II. Signed-Out Users

Initial Request for Consent

Signed-out users who arrive at the Google Maps CPS's web surfaces in the EEA are presented with a banner asking if they would like to consent to the use of cookies and data for the purposes of showing a personalised user experience and personalised ads, among other purposes. Users have the option to click equally weighted "Accept all," "Reject all," or "More options" buttons. A User who selects "More options" is presented with equally weighted "off" and "on" options to (i) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise a user's experience or (ii) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise ads. A user can then confirm their consent choices or reject the use of cookies and data for all purposes requiring consent by choosing to "Reject all."

Settings

Signed-out users can change their consent choices described above by visiting g.co/privacytools.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation controlled by these consents.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

Google requires third parties who use ads services to ensure user consent is obtained for the use of cookies or other local storage where legally required and for the collection, sharing, and use of personal data with Google for ads personalisation purposes. Third parties that must ensure user consent is obtained include publishers, advertisers, data management platforms and third party exchanges.

Means by which a third party may collect user consent

Third parties must use a valid means to obtain user consent and may use an in-house solution or a Consent Management Platform. In any event, the solution used must comply with local regulations and Google's policies including our [Consent Policy](#) for the EU. To support our customers, we provide [guidance](#) on how to comply with this policy and how Google validates compliance.

How a user can withdraw consent

Users must be able to revoke their consent through the consent flows provided by third parties. Our Consent Policy for the EU requires that users are informed about how they can do so. At a minimum, users must be able to easily reach their consent settings on the respective site or app.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially

higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The Google Maps CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

l) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work. Examples for such potential alternatives are provided below:

- **Age assurance:** For age assurance, profiling allows us to infer the user's age in a minimally intrusive manner. As an alternative, users could be asked to provide and prove their age with legal documentation, which would have to be verified, and users verified as adults would have to remain signed-in at all times to benefit from all of Google's services. While some users may prove their age, for instance, with government IDs, this alternative is generally not preferred as not all users have access to government issued identification or would wish to provide it.
- **Fraud and abuse:** For the detection of fraud and abuse in the context of advertisements, advertisers could rely on their own human review instead of profiling by Google. This would risk detecting less invalid activity or bad actors, as it would leave fraud and abuse detection up to varying levels of technology and capabilities of individual advertisers and potentially other third party companies. The scale, speed, and diversity of attempts to attack and abuse our advertising network require sophisticated automated detection and significant expertise to keep a safe advertising environment for users and prevent attempts to defraud advertisers through various types of invalid activity. Also, effective fraud and abuse detection outsourced to third parties would very likely involve similar profiling techniques as the ones used by Google. The use of these third parties, with varying degrees of capabilities and expertise, would impose unnecessary financial burden on advertisers, while increasing the potential for fragmentation in the approach, classification, and mitigation of invalid activity.

4) Profiling Techniques of Users - Google Play CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and Google Play as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). Google Play is used for the same purpose from both a user and a customer perspective, irrespective of the device and of the type of content: to intermediate the distribution of digital content available through Google Play. In addition, the European Commission defined the Google Play CPS to also include advertisements displayed on Google Play. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the Google Play CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic Play and ads results. If any consumer facing product or feature within the Google Play CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing consumers with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, (h) how we seek user consent, and (i) how we seek user consent through third parties. Links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. In some cases, Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The Google Play CPS further ensures a high level of transparency for users through additional measures. Google requires the clear labelling of ads and sponsored content to distinguish it from organic content, and provides in-ad disclosures to make it easy for users to understand why specific ads are shown, what information is used and how users can control their Google ad experience. Users can access specific Help Center articles to understand how app privacy and security practices are [secured for Google Play's data](#) and how [search results work on Google Play](#).

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as Web & App Activity, YouTube History and the Personalised Ads setting to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the Google Play CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The Google Play CPS, as defined by the European Commission, conducts user profiling for personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support, fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as for compliance and other legally required purposes. As described above, the European Commission's definition of the Google Play CPS also includes advertisements displayed on Google Play; data can be used to improve the overall quality of these ads.

For personalisation and/or customisation of products, services and support, profiling helps the Google Play CPS to provide the user with a personalised experience of relevant content and assistance. To help protect users, customers and the wider online community, and keep the internet helpful and safer for all, the Google Play CPS carefully analyses information to identify and stop fraud, spam and other harmful online activities. Finally, the Google Play CPS uses certain profiling techniques for compliance and legal purposes. For instance, this helps to determine if a user is a minor so that we can implement safeguards for minors where required by law. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, Google Play CPS uses various machine learning classifications, clustering methods, recommender/ranking systems, regressions and tailored rules.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Play as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the Google Play CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data processed for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Play CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Play CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the Google Play CPS:

- **Content users create, upload or receive:** This includes content that users create, upload, or receive when using Google's services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personal information users provide to Google services:** This includes settings made by the user for Google Ads Personalisation and user survey data. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which

includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google Services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services. The level of granularity of the location data depends, in particular, on the relevant profiling purpose. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Other information from our trusted partners:** This includes information about users from Google's third party trusted partners, e.g., information provided by Google's marketing partners, security partners, and advertising partners. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Play as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for Google Play CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data inferred for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Play CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Play CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Demographics:** This includes a user's demographics such as gender or age. Demographics may be used, for example, to protect minors in line with legal obligations or to provide more relevant

advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Attributes:** Attributes include general, non-sensitive interests and affinities of users that can be inferred, such as interests in coffee shops or restaurants. These may be used, for example, to improve the relevance of a user's experience and advertisements shown to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to provide more relevant and comprehensible content in the language of the user. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include rankings and providing more relevant content, search query results, offers and/or advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Statistical inferences about user interactions:** These inferences may be used to detect invalid traffic and to provide more relevant apps and advertisements to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Data for anti-abuse purposes:** Data for anti-abuse purposes includes inferences about the likelihood that certain requests are coming from invalid traffic and other information to identify harmful or unlawful content. This data may be used, for example, to protect our users, customers, the general public and Google's systems against fraud and abuse. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Play CPS, which includes organic play and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The Google Play CPS utilises profiling techniques to personalise and/or customise products and services, provide personalised support, show relevant ads to users, to detect and prevent fraud and abuse, as well as for general legal and compliance purposes. This is important for the Google Play CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

Personalisation of user experience

- The Google Play CPS employs user profiling to provide users with more relevant and helpful advertisements, as well as to better match ads to the user's (main) language. This also helps advertisers to tailor their advertising messages to resonate with specific groups.
- The Google Play CPS provides personalised support to users using Google's products and services.
- The Google Play CPS employs user profiling techniques to personalise app recommendations, making them more relevant to the user and prevents underage users from accessing mature content.

Fraud and abuse detection and general legal purposes

- Google employs user profiling techniques to determine if an interaction with an ad is [invalid](#). This helps Google to combat a number of different forms of fraud, such as false representation of domains, "clickjacking" (a web attack where the appearance of a website is changed so that a user does not realise they are clicking on an ad) and fake traffic that originates from computers infected with malware (so-called "botnets"). For example, Google was able to help take down the [major online fraud operation](#) called "3ve" which generated billions of fraudulent ad bid requests (i.e., ad spaces on web pages that advertisers can bid to purchase in an automated way) which led to the dismantling of two international cybercriminal rings.
- Besides assessing the user's age, Google also employs user profiling techniques to ensure users and developers have a safe and secure purchase experience by detecting, for example, purchases made by a compromised form of payment or a refund request for an in-app purchase that has been already consumed or sold, or use scammed gift cards for purchases; and avoiding fraudulent and abusive transactions. In 2020, Google Play was able to remove nearly 600 apps from the Google Play Store and the ad monetisation platforms Google AdMob and Google Ad Manager for showing disruptive ads either while using an app or out of context, while users were not actually on the app. In 2022, this helped Google to prevent over USD 2 billion in fraudulent and abusive transactions globally.

Some profiling activities for certain, narrowly defined, or legally required purposes, especially for fraud and abuse detection, may be applied to all our users. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The Google Play CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview, below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the Google Play CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (a) and (f) GDPR to provide personalised services, including personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support and personalisation of ads (when ads are personalised, we ask for consent). To protect the Google Play CPS, our users, and the public, the Google Play CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (c), and (f) GDPR. This includes processing for the purpose of fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as compliance and legal purposes, law enforcement requests and incident management.

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for Google Play CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

Google uses three settings to seek consent from signed-in users for certain forms of personalisation that are relevant for the Google Play CPS and may involve profiling: i) Web & App Activity; ii) YouTube History; and iii) Personalised Ads. Users are asked to make a choice about the Web & App Activity, YouTube History, and Personalised Ads settings during the Google account creation process.

Account Creation Process

Users are asked if they would like to consent to the forms of personalisation controlled by these settings during the account creation process. Google offers two paths during account creation, an "Express" path that allows the user to make choices about multiple settings in a single step, and a "Manual" path that allows users to make a choice about each setting on a different screen. Users are able to go back to prior screens and switch between these paths during the account creation process. In both paths, users are presented with information about: (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

During the “Express” and “Manual” paths, users are informed that they can change their settings and withdraw their consent by visiting account.google.com after they have created their account. Users who visit these controls are able to toggle these settings on or off and delete data subject to the Web & App Activity and YouTube History settings at any time.

A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Web & App Activity or YouTube History settings by turning the respective setting off and deleting data that has been previously saved to the user’s account pursuant to the respective setting. Users also have the option to turn either of the settings off without deleting saved data, which will stop new activity data from being saved to their account pursuant to the respective setting, but not withdraw consent for personalisation based on existing saved data⁵. A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Personalised Ads setting by turning the setting off at any time.

Users who want to turn these settings on after account creation are presented with the same substantive information that is presented during account creation about (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user could manage that data processing.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation that are controlled by these consents. A user who has set their Web & App Activity settings and YouTube History settings to off will also not have certain data about their activity saved to their account while those settings are off.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

Google requires third parties who use ads services to ensure user consent is obtained for the use of cookies or other local storage where legally required and for the collection, sharing, and use of personal data with Google for ads personalisation purposes. Third parties that must ensure user consent is obtained include publishers, advertisers, data management platforms and third party exchanges.

Means by which a third party may collect user consent

Third parties must use a valid means to obtain user consent and may use an in-house solution or a Consent Management Platform. In any event, the solution used must comply with local regulations and Google’s policies including our [Consent Policy](#) for the EU. To support our customers, we provide [guidance](#) on how to comply with this policy and how Google validates compliance.

⁵ Google Play does not currently personalise the user experience using existing saved data when Web & App Activity is off.

How a user can withdraw consent

Users must be able to revoke their consent through the consent flows provided by third parties. Our Consent Policy for the EU requires that users are informed about how they can do so. At a minimum, users must be able to easily reach their consent settings on the respective site or app.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The Google Play CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

l) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work. Examples for such potential alternatives are provided below:

- **Age assurance:** For age assurance, profiling allows us to infer the user's age in a minimally intrusive manner. As an alternative, users could be asked to provide and prove their age with legal documentation, which would have to be verified, and users verified as adults would have to remain signed-in at all times to benefit from all of Google's services. While some users may prove their age for instance with government IDs, this alternative is generally not preferred as not all users have access to government issued identification or would wish to provide it.
- **Fraud and abuse:** For the detection of fraud and abuse in the context of advertisements, advertisers could rely on their own human review instead of profiling by Google. This would risk detecting less invalid activity or bad actors, as it would leave fraud and abuse detection up to varying levels of technology and capabilities of individual advertisers and potentially other third party companies. The scale, speed, and diversity of attempts to attack and abuse our advertising network require sophisticated automated detection and significant expertise to keep a safe advertising environment for users and prevent attempts to defraud advertisers through various types of invalid activity. Also, effective fraud and abuse detection outsourced to third parties would very likely involve similar profiling techniques as the ones used by Google. The use of these third parties, with varying degrees of capabilities and expertise, would impose unnecessary financial burden on advertisers, while increasing the potential for fragmentation in the approach, classification, and mitigation of invalid activity.

5) Profiling Techniques of Users - Google Search CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and Google Search as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). Google Search allows users to enter queries on any subject on its online and app interfaces, which return ranked search results in response to those queries. In addition, the Google Search CPS also includes advertisements displayed on Google Search. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the Google Search CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. If any consumer facing product or feature within the Google Search CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing consumers with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, (h) how we seek user consent, and (i) how we seek user consent through third parties. Links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

In addition to the consents discussed in section (h), the Google Search CPS also provides a control that allows users to turn-off personalisation of search results even if Web & App Activity is enabled. More information on the personalisation of search results can be found [here](#).

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The Google Search CPS further ensures a high level of transparency through additional measures. Google requires the clear labelling of ads and sponsored content to distinguish it from organic content,

and provides in-ad disclosures to make it easy for users to understand why specific ads are shown, what information is used and how users can control their Google ad experience.

Users can click on the three dots next to a search result to view the “About this result” information, which indicates whether the result was personalised, and provides links to the relevant personalisation controls. Users can access specific Help Center articles to understand how [Google Search works in general](#) or how [personalisation of search results](#) works, how to manage and delete their [history](#) or how to manage their location while using Google Search. Similarly, users can access the [Google Safety Center](#) to learn how Google Search protects their data and how to use Google Search’s privacy controls.

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as Web & App Activity and the Personalised Ads setting to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the Google Search CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The Google Search CPS, as defined by the European Commission, conducts user profiling for personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support, fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as for compliance and other legally required purposes. As described above, the European Commission’s definition of the Google Search CPS also includes advertisements displayed on Google Search; data can be used to improve the overall quality of these ads.

For personalisation and/or customisation of products, services and support, profiling helps the Google Search CPS to provide the user with a personalised user experience of relevant content and assistance. To help protect users, customers and the wider online community, and keep the internet helpful and safer for all, the Google Search CPS carefully analyses information to identify and stop fraud, spam and other harmful online activities. Finally, the Google Search CPS uses certain profiling techniques for compliance and legal purposes. For instance, this helps us to determine if a user is a minor so that we can implement safeguards for minors where required by law. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, the Google Search CPS uses various machine learning classifications, clustering methods, recommender/ranking systems, regressions, and tailored rules.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Search as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the Google Search CPS’s services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data processed for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Search CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse

measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Search CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the Google Search CPS:

- **Content users create, upload or receive:** This includes content that users create, upload, or receive when using Google's services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personal information users provide to Google services:** This includes settings made by the user for Google Ads Personalisation and user survey data. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google Services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services. The level of granularity of the location data depends, in particular, on the relevant profiling purpose. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Other information from our trusted partners:** This includes information about users from Google's third party trusted partners, e.g., information provided by Google's marketing partners, security partners, and advertising partners. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Search as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for Google Search CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data inferred for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Search CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Search CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Attributes:** Attributes include general, non-sensitive interests and affinities of users that can be inferred, such as interests in coffee shops or restaurants. These may be used, for example, to improve the relevance of a user's experience and advertisements shown to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Location:** This category includes inferred user location information. Location information may be used, for example, to enforce legal and regulatory restrictions, to provide more relevant advertisements, and to provide information in the right language. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to provide more relevant and comprehensible content in the language of the user. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include ranking and providing more relevant content, search query results, offers and/or advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Demographics:** This includes a user's demographics such as gender or age. Demographics may be used, for example, to protect minors in line with legal obligations or to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Statistical inferences about user interactions:** These inferences may be used to detect invalid traffic, and to provide more relevant advertisements to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Data for anti-abuse purposes:** Data for anti-abuse purposes includes inferences about the likelihood that certain requests are coming from invalid traffic and other information to identify harmful or unlawful content. This data may be used, for example, to protect our users, customers, the general public and Google's systems against fraud and abuse. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Search CPS, which includes organic search and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The Google Search CPS utilises profiling techniques to personalise and/or customise products and services, provide personalised support, show relevant ads to users, to detect and prevent fraud and abuse as well as for general legal and compliance purposes. This is important for the Google Search CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

Personalisation of user experience

- The Google Search CPS personalises the user experience, including by providing information that is more relevant.
- Advertisements shown on the Google Search CPS provide users with more relevant and helpful advertisements, as well as to better match ads to the user's (main) language. This also helps advertisers to tailor their advertising messages to resonate with specific groups.
- The Google Search CPS provides personalised support to users using Google's products and services.

Fraud and abuse detection and general legal purposes

- Google employs user profiling techniques to determine if an interaction with an ad is [invalid](#). This helps Google to combat a number of different forms of fraud, such as false representation of domains, "clickjacking" (a web attack where the appearance of a website is changed so that a user does not realise they are clicking on an ad) and fake traffic that originates from computers infected with malware (so-called "botnets"). For example, Google was able to help take down the [major online fraud operation](#) called "3ve" which generated billions of fraudulent ad bid requests (i.e., ad spaces on web pages that advertisers can bid to purchase in an automated way) which led to the dismantling of two international cybercriminal rings.

Some profiling activities for certain, narrowly defined, or legally required purposes, especially for fraud and abuse detection, may be applied to all our users. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The Google Search CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview, below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the Google Search CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (a) and (f) GDPR to provide personalised services, including personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support and personalisation of ads (when ads are personalised, we ask for consent). To protect the Google Search CPS, our users, and the public, the Google Search CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (c) and (f) GDPR. This includes processing for the purpose of fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as compliance and legal purposes, law enforcement requests and incident management.

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for the Google Search CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

I. Signed-In Users

Google uses three settings to seek consent from signed-in users for certain forms of personalisation that are relevant for the Google Search CPS and may involve profiling: i) Web & App Activity; ii) YouTube History; and iii) Personalised Ads. Users are asked to make a choice about the Web & App Activity, YouTube History, and Personalised Ads settings during the Google account creation process.

Account Creation Process

Users are asked if they would like to consent to the forms of personalisation controlled by these settings during the account creation process. Google offers two paths during account creation, an “Express” path that allows the user to make choices about multiple settings in a single step, and a “Manual” path that allows users to make a choice about each setting on a different screen. Users are able to go back to prior screens and switch between these paths during the account creation process. In both paths, users are presented with information about: (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

During the “Express” and “Manual” paths, users are informed that they can change their settings and withdraw their consent by visiting account.google.com after they have created their account. Users who visit these controls are able to toggle these settings on or off and delete data subject to the Web & App Activity and YouTube History settings at any time.

A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Web & App Activity or YouTube History settings by turning the respective setting off and deleting data that has been previously saved to the user’s account pursuant to the respective setting. Users also have the option to turn either of the settings off without deleting saved data, which will stop new activity data from being saved to their account pursuant to the respective setting, but not withdraw consent for personalisation based on existing saved data. A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Personalised Ads setting by turning the setting off at any time.

Users who want to turn these settings on after account creation are presented with the same substantive information that is presented during account creation about (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user could manage that data processing.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalised experiences that are controlled by these consents. A user who has set their Web & App Activity settings and YouTube History settings to off will also not have certain data about their activity saved to their account while those settings are off.

II. Signed-Out Users

Initial Request for Consent

Signed-out users who arrive at the Google Search CPS’s web surfaces in the EEA are presented with a banner asking if they would like to consent to the use of cookies and data for the purposes of showing a personalised user experience and personalised ads, among other purposes. Users have the option to click equally weighted “Accept all,” “Reject all,” or “More options” buttons. A user who selects “More options” is presented with equally weighted “off” and “on” options to (i) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise a user’s experience or (ii) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise ads. A user can then confirm their consent choices or reject the use of cookies and data for all purposes requiring consent by choosing to “Reject all.”

Settings

Signed-out users can change their consent choices described above by visiting g.co/privacytools.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalised experiences controlled by these consents.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

Google requires third parties who use ads services to ensure user consent is obtained for the use of cookies or other local storage where legally required and for the collection, sharing, and use of personal data with Google for ads personalisation purposes. Third parties that must ensure user consent is obtained include publishers, advertisers, data management platforms and third party exchanges.

Means by which a third party may collect user consent

Third parties must use a valid means to obtain user consent and may use an in-house solution or a Consent Management Platform. In any event, the solution used must comply with local regulations and Google's policies including our [Consent Policy](#) for the EU. To support our customers, we provide [guidance](#) on how to comply with this policy and how Google validates compliance.

How a user can withdraw consent

Users must be able to revoke their consent through the consent flows provided by third parties. Our Consent Policy for the EU requires that users are informed about how they can do so. At a minimum, users must be able to easily reach their consent settings on the respective site or app.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The Google Search CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

I) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work. Examples for such potential alternatives are provided below:

- **Age assurance:** For age assurance, profiling allows us to infer the user's age in a minimally intrusive manner. As an alternative, users could be asked to provide and prove their age with legal documentation, which would have to be verified, and users verified as adults would have to remain signed-in at all times to benefit from all of Google's services. While some users may prove their age for instance with government IDs, this alternative is generally not preferred as not all users have access to government issued identification or would wish to provide it.
- **Fraud and abuse:** For the detection of fraud and abuse in the context of advertisements, advertisers could rely on their own human review instead of profiling by Google. This would risk detecting less invalid activity or bad actors, as it would leave fraud and abuse detection up to varying levels of technology and capabilities of individual advertisers and potentially other third party companies. The scale, speed, and diversity of attempts to attack and abuse our advertising network require sophisticated automated detection and significant expertise to keep a safe advertising environment for users and prevent attempts to defraud advertisers through various types of invalid activity. Also, effective fraud and abuse detection outsourced to third parties would very likely involve similar profiling techniques as the ones used by Google. The use of these third parties, with varying degrees of capabilities and expertise, would impose unnecessary financial burden on advertisers, while increasing the potential for fragmentation in the approach, classification, and mitigation of invalid activity.

6) Profiling Techniques of Users - Google Shopping CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and Google Shopping as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). Google Shopping allows users to discover and compare product offers as displayed on the service. In addition, the European Commission defined the Google Shopping CPS to also include advertisements displayed on Google Shopping. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the Google Shopping CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. If any consumer facing product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing consumers with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, (h) how we seek user consent, and (i) how we seek user consent through third parties. Links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. In some cases, Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The Google Shopping CPS further ensures a high level of transparency for users through additional measures. Google requires the clear labelling of ads and sponsored content to distinguish it from organic content, and provides in-ad disclosures to make it easy for users to understand why specific ads are shown, what information is used and how users can control their Google ad experience. Users can see and control their activity via [My Google Activity](#) and can find specific [Help Center articles](#) to understand how ads privacy works in Google Shopping.

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as Web & App Activity and the Personalised Ads setting to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the Google Shopping CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The Google Shopping CPS, as defined by the European Commission, conducts user profiling for personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support, fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as for compliance and other legally required purposes. As described above, the European Commission's definition of the Google Shopping CPS also includes advertisements displayed on Google Shopping; data can be used to improve the overall quality of these ads.

For personalisation and/or customisation of products, services and support, profiling helps the Google Shopping CPS to provide the user with a personalised experience of relevant content and assistance. To help protect users, customers and the wider online community, and keep the internet helpful and safer for all, the Google Shopping CPS carefully analyses information to identify and stop fraud, spam and other harmful online activities. Finally, the Google Shopping CPS uses certain profiling techniques for compliance and legal purposes. For instance, this helps to determine if a user is a minor so that we can implement safeguards for minors where required by law. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, Google Shopping CPS uses various machine learning classifications, clustering methods, recommender/ranking systems, regressions, and tailored rules.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Shopping as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the Google Shopping CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data processed for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Shopping CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Shopping CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the Google Shopping CPS:

- **Personal information users provide to Google services:** This includes settings made by the user for Google Ads Personalisation and user survey data. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google Services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services. The level of granularity of the location data depends, in particular, on the relevant profiling purpose. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Other information from our trusted partners:** This includes information about users from Google's third party trusted partners, e.g., information provided by Google's marketing partners, security partners, and advertising partners. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined Google Shopping as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for the Google Shopping CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data inferred for other services, including advertisements shown on the Google Shopping CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The Google Shopping CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Demographics:** This includes a user's demographics such as gender or age. Demographics may be used, for example, to protect minors in line with legal obligations or to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is

committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Attributes:** Attributes include general, non-sensitive interests and affinities of users that can be inferred, such as interests in coffee shops or restaurants. These may be used, for example, to improve the relevance of a user's experience and advertisements shown to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Location:** This category includes inferred user location information. Location information may be used, for example, to enforce legal and regulatory restrictions, and to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to provide more relevant and comprehensible content in the language of the user. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include ranking and providing more relevant content, search query results, offers and/or advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Statistical inferences about user interactions:** These inferences may be used to detect invalid traffic and to provide more relevant advertisements to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Data for anti-abuse purposes:** Data for anti-abuse purposes includes inferences about the likelihood that certain requests are coming from invalid traffic and other information to identify harmful or unlawful content. This data may be used, for example, to protect our users, customers, the general public and Google's systems against fraud and abuse. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the Google Shopping CPS, which includes organic shopping and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The Google Shopping CPS utilises profiling techniques to personalise and/or customise products and services, provide personalised support, show relevant ads to users, to detect and prevent fraud and abuse as well as for general legal and compliance purposes. This is important for the Google Shopping CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

Personalisation of user experience

- The Google Shopping CPS employs user profiling techniques to personalise users' shopping experience and provide more relevant shopping results.
- The Google Shopping CPS employs user profiling to provide users with more relevant and helpful advertisements, as well as to better match ads to the user's (main) language. This also helps advertisers to tailor their advertising messages to resonate with specific groups.
- The Google Shopping CPS provides personalised support to users using Google's products and services.

Fraud and abuse detection and general legal purposes

- Google employs user profiling techniques to determine if an interaction with an ad is [invalid](#). This helps Google to combat a number of different forms of fraud, such as false representation of domains, "clickjacking" (a web attack where the appearance of a website is changed so that a user does not realise they are clicking on an ad) and fake traffic that originates from computers infected with malware (so-called "botnets"). For example, Google was able to help take down the [major online fraud operation](#) called "3ve" which generated billions of fraudulent ad bid requests (i.e., ad spaces on web pages that advertisers can bid to purchase in an automated way) which led to the dismantling of two international cybercriminal rings.

Some profiling activities for certain, narrowly defined, or legally required purposes, especially for fraud and abuse detection, may be applied to all our users. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The Google Shopping CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview, below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the Google Shopping CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (a) and (f) GDPR to provide personalised services, including the personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support and personalisation of ads (when ads are personalised, we ask for consent). To protect the Google Shopping CPS, our users, and the public, the Google Shopping CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (c) and (f) GDPR. This includes processing for the purpose of compliance and legal purposes, law enforcement requests and incident management.

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for Google Shopping CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

I. Signed-In Users

Google uses two settings to seek consent from signed-in users for certain forms of personalisation that are relevant for the Google Shopping CPS and may involve profiling: i) Web & App Activity and ii) Personalised Ads. Users are asked to make a choice about the Web & App Activity and Personalised Ads settings during the Google account creation process.

Account Creation Process

Users are asked if they would like to consent to the forms of personalisation controlled by these settings during the account creation process. Google offers two paths during account creation, an "Express" path that allows the user to make choices about multiple settings in a single step, and a "Manual" path that allows users to make a choice about each setting on a different screen. Users are able to go back to prior screens and switch between these paths during the account creation process. In both paths, users are presented with information about: (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

During the "Express" and "Manual" paths, users are informed that they can change their settings and withdraw their consent by visiting account.google.com after they have created their account. Users who visit these controls are able to toggle these settings on or off and delete data subject to the Web & App Activity setting at any time.

A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Web & App Activity setting by turning the setting off and deleting data that has been previously saved to the user's account pursuant to the setting. Users also have the option to turn the setting off without deleting saved data,

which will stop new activity data from being saved to their account pursuant to the setting, but not withdraw consent for personalisation based on existing saved data. A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Personalised Ads setting by turning the setting off at any time.

Users who want to turn these settings on after account creation are presented with the same substantive information that is presented during account creation about (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation that are controlled by these consents. A user who has set their Web & App Activity setting to off will also not have certain data about their activity saved to their account while the setting is off.

II. Signed-Out Users

Initial Request for Consent

Signed-out users who arrive at the Google Shopping CPS's web surface in the EEA are presented with a banner asking if they would like to consent to the use of cookies and data for the purposes of showing a personalised user experience and showing personalised ads, among other purposes. Users have the option to click equally weighted "Accept all," "Reject all," or "More options" buttons. A user who selects "More options" is presented with equally weighted "off" and "on" options to (i) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise a user's experience or (ii) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise ads. A user can then confirm their consent choices or reject the use of cookies and data for all purposes requiring consent by choosing to "Reject all."

Settings

Signed-out users can change their consent choices described above by visiting g.co/privacytools.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation controlled by these consents.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

Google requires third parties who use ads services to ensure user consent is obtained for the use of cookies or other local storage where legally required and for the collection, sharing, and use of personal data with Google for ads personalisation purposes. Third parties that must ensure user consent is obtained include publishers, advertisers, data management platforms and third party exchanges.

Means by which a third party may collect user consent

Third parties must use a valid means to obtain user consent and may use an in-house solution or a Consent Management Platform. In any event, the solution used must comply with local regulations and Google's policies including our [Consent Policy](#) for the EU. To support our customers, we provide [guidance](#) on how to comply with this policy and how Google validates compliance.

How a user can withdraw consent

Users must be able to revoke their consent through the consent flows provided by third parties. Our Consent Policy for the EU requires that users are informed about how they can do so. At a minimum, users must be able to easily reach their consent settings on the respective site or app.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The Google Shopping CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

l) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work. Examples for such potential alternatives are provided below:

- **Age assurance:** For age assurance, profiling allows us to infer the user's age in a minimally intrusive manner. As an alternative, users could be asked to provide and prove their age with legal documentation, which would have to be verified, and users verified as adults would have to remain signed-in at all times to benefit from all of Google's services. While some users may prove their age for instance with government IDs, this alternative is generally not preferred as not all users have access to government issued identification or would wish to provide it.
- **Fraud and abuse:** For the detection of fraud and abuse in the context of advertisements, advertisers could rely on their own human review instead of profiling by Google. This would risk detecting less invalid activity or bad actors, as it would leave fraud and abuse detection up to varying levels of technology and capabilities of individual advertisers and potentially other third party companies. The scale, speed, and diversity of attempts to attack and abuse our advertising network require sophisticated automated detection and significant expertise to keep a safe advertising environment for users and prevent attempts to defraud advertisers

through various types of invalid activity. Also, effective fraud and abuse detection outsourced to third parties would very likely involve similar profiling techniques as the ones used by Google. The use of these third parties, with varying degrees of capabilities and expertise, would impose unnecessary financial burden on advertisers, while increasing the potential for fragmentation in the approach, classification, and mitigation of invalid activity.

7) Profiling Techniques of Users - YouTube CPS

The European Commission designated Alphabet as a gatekeeper and YouTube as a Core Platform Service (CPS) according to Art. 3 Digital Markets Act (DMA). YouTube enables users and creators to make audio-visual content available to other users in order to inform, entertain or educate and for users to explore, watch, listen to and share that content. In addition, the European Commission defined the YouTube CPS to also include advertisements displayed on YouTube. We provide more details on the user profiling techniques utilised for the YouTube CPS in the European Union as of 1 January 2024 below.

The profiling described below is not necessarily used by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. If any consumer facing product or feature within the YouTube CPS uses any type of data that falls into this category, the category is included in this report. Google is committed to providing consumers with transparency and control over how their data is processed, including for profiling. These tools are described at sections (a) our commitment to transparency and control, (h) how we seek user consent, and (i) how we seek user consent through third parties. Links to more information are in the introduction to this document.

a) Our commitment to transparency and control

Transparency

Google believes being transparent about how we handle privacy, security, and access to information empowers users and encourages progress toward a safer, more secure web. To uphold our commitment to transparency, Google provides transparency reports and shares how content recommendations work across Google products and services in the [Transparency Center](#). The Transparency Center [shows users](#) how different products have unique approaches to recommendations and how users can adjust their settings.

Google further notifies users about the use of their data in the [Privacy Policy](#), including the use of their data to personalise Google's products and services, to provide an improved user experience, and to deliver personalised advertising that may be more relevant for the user. In addition, Google notifies users about the use of their data for detecting, preventing, and responding to fraud, abuse, security risks, and technical issues that could harm our users, customers, the public or Google's services. In some cases, Google also notifies users during the Google Account creation process, via the account settings page, through in-product notifications, and Help Center articles.

The YouTube CPS further ensures a high level of transparency through additional measures. YouTube requires the clear labelling of ads and sponsored content to distinguish it from organic content, and provides in-ad disclosures to make it easy for users to understand why specific ads are shown, what information is used and how users can [control their YouTube ad experience](#).

Users can also access specific Help Center articles to understand the basics of privacy on [YouTube](#) and how YouTube [maintains data privacy](#), how signed-in parents can create a separate profile for their

[children](#), how users can [manage their data](#) specifically while using YouTube, as well as understand [YouTube Analytics](#) viewership data and how the [YouTube recommendations](#) system works.

Control

In addition to our commitment to transparency Google provides users with controls to manage their data at Google. As described in more detail in section (h) of this CPS overview below, Google provides users with tools such as the Personalised Ads setting and YouTube History to determine what data Google can retain and for how long, and whether and how the YouTube CPS uses this data for providing personalised user experiences.

b) Why and how we process data

The YouTube CPS, as defined by the European Commission, conducts user profiling for personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support, fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as for compliance and other legally required purposes. As described above, the European Commission's definition of the YouTube CPS also includes advertisements displayed on YouTube; data can be used to improve the overall quality of these ads.

For personalisation and/or customisation of products, services and support, profiling helps the YouTube CPS to provide the user with a personalised experience of relevant content and assistance. To help protect users, customers and the wider online community, and keep the internet helpful and safer for all, the YouTube CPS carefully analyses information to identify and stop fraud, spam and other harmful online activities. Finally, the YouTube CPS uses certain profiling techniques for compliance and legal purposes. For instance, this helps to determine if a user is a minor so that we can implement safeguards for minors where required by law. To enable the above-mentioned uses of profiling, YouTube CPS uses various machine learning classifications, clustering methods, recommender/ranking systems, regressions, and tailored rules.

c) What data we process

As described above, the European Commission has defined YouTube as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data processed for the YouTube CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data processed for other services, including advertisements shown on the YouTube CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The YouTube CPS and/or other Google services process data in the following data categories for profiling applied within the YouTube CPS:

- **Content users create, upload or receive:** This includes content that users create, upload, or receive when using Google's services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

- **Personal information users provide to Google services:** This includes settings made by the user for Google Ads Personalisation and user survey data. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' apps, browsers and devices:** This includes data about the apps, browsers, and devices used by the user, which Google collects when users interact with its services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Information about users' activity on Google services or third party sites and apps that use Google services:** This includes data about a user's activity such as search terms, views and interactions with Google content and services. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **User location information:** This includes information about the physical location of a user based on their usage of Google services. The level of granularity of the location data depends, in particular, on the relevant profiling purpose and the user's chosen settings. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Other information from our trusted partners:** This includes information about users from Google's third party trusted partners, e.g., information provided by Google's marketing partners, security partners, and advertising partners. Data from this category is not necessarily used for profiling by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

More information about user control over data can be found below under (h) and (i) of this CPS overview and in our [Privacy Policy](#).

d) What data we infer

As described above, the European Commission has defined YouTube as a CPS and requires us to provide information about data inferred for YouTube CPS's services and the provision of personalised support. It also requires information about data inferred for other services, including advertisements shown on the YouTube CPS as well as fraud detection and counter abuse measures, compliance and other legally required purposes. The YouTube CPS infers data in the following data categories:

- **Demographics:** This includes a user's demographics such as gender or age. Demographics may be used, for example, to protect minors in line with legal obligations or to provide more relevant advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Attributes:** Attributes include general, non-sensitive interests and affinities of users, that can be inferred, such as interests in sports or music. These may be used, for example, to improve the relevance of a user's experience and advertisements shown to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Location:** This category includes inferred user location information. Location information may be used, for example, to enforce legal and regulatory restrictions, and to provide more relevant videos and advertisements. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Language:** This category includes information about the language(s) used by a user. Language information may be used, for example, to provide more relevant and comprehensible videos and content in the language of the user. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Personalised and/or customised recommendations/rankings:** These include rankings and providing more relevant content, search query results, offers and/or advertisements. These personalised recommendations and rankings may be used, for example, to provide more relevant videos, advertisements, suggestions and responses to queries. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Statistical inferences about user interactions:** These inferences may be used to detect invalid traffic and to provide more relevant advertisements to users. Data from this category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.
- **Data for anti-abuse purposes:** Data for anti-abuse purposes includes inferences about the likelihood that certain requests are coming from invalid traffic and other information to identify harmful or unlawful content. This data may be used, for example, to protect our users, customers, the general public and Google's systems against fraud and abuse. Data from this

category is not necessarily inferred by every product or feature within the YouTube CPS, which includes organic YouTube and ads results. Google is committed to providing users with transparency and control over how their data is processed, as described in sections (a), (h) and (i) of this CPS overview.

e) Why does this matter?

The YouTube CPS utilises profiling techniques to personalise products and services, to provide personalised support, to personalise ads and promotions, to detect and prevent fraud and abuse, as well as for general legal and compliance purposes. This is important for the YouTube CPS to provide the products and services offered and to ensure a safe and trustworthy environment for users. Examples of why this matters include:

Personalisation of user experience

- The YouTube CPS employs user profiling to provide users with more relevant and helpful advertisements, as well as to better match ads to the user's (main) language. This also helps advertisers to tailor their advertising messages to resonate with specific groups.
- The YouTube CPS employs user profiling techniques to provide personalised support to users using Google's products and services.
- The YouTube CPS employs user profiling techniques to personalise the user's experience on YouTube, for example, by providing relevant video recommendations and avoiding irrelevant and redundant content.

Fraud and abuse detection and general legal purposes

- Google employs user profiling techniques to determine if an interaction with an ad is [invalid](#). This helps Google to combat a number of different forms of fraud, such as false representation of domains, "clickjacking" (a web attack where the appearance of a website is changed so that a user does not realise they are clicking on an ad) and fake traffic that originates from computers infected with malware (so-called "botnets"). For example, Google was able to help take down the [major online fraud operation](#) called "3ve" which generated billions of fraudulent ad bid requests (i.e., ad spaces on web pages that advertisers can bid to purchase in an automated way) which led to the dismantling of two international cybercriminal rings.
- YouTube employs user profiling techniques to detect abusive accounts and generally fight fraud and abuse. Uncaught abusive accounts may lead to harm to users, customers and Google due to malicious actions.

Some profiling activities for certain, narrowly defined, or legally required purposes, especially for fraud and abuse detection, may be applied to all our users. However, we ensure that users have the appropriate controls to manage their experiences.

Please see sections (a) and (h) of this CPS overview for additional helpful resources.

f) How long we retain the data

Data is retained for different periods of time depending on what it is, how it is used, and how the user configures their settings. The YouTube CPS processes personal data in accordance with [Google's Privacy Policy](#) and [retention statement](#). In particular, Google provides user controls that enable users to choose to retain or delete certain data processed for different purposes which may include profiling. Such data is retained depending on the respective settings chosen by users. For more information on these controls, see section (h) of this CPS overview below.

For data that is not subject to user control, defined maximum retention durations for profiling uses in general are in place. For systems-security, fraud and abuse prevention, safety and age assurance profiling uses, these defined maximum retention durations are generally longer. In addition, data may be retained for longer periods for other non-profiling uses, including to comply with legal obligations.

g) Legal grounds

To process personal data for profiling, the YouTube CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (a) and (f) GDPR to provide personalised services, including personalisation and/or customisation of products and services, provision of personalised support and personalisation of ads (when ads are personalised, we ask for consent). To protect the YouTube CPS, our users, and the public, the YouTube CPS relies on Art. 6(1) (c) and (f) GDPR. This includes processing for the purpose of fraud detection and counter abuse measures as well as compliance and legal purposes, law enforcement requests and incident management.

Art. 9 GDPR, which covers generally sensitive categories of personal data, is not applicable for YouTube CPS's use of profiling.

h) How we seek user consent

I. Signed-In Users

Google uses two settings to seek consent from signed-in users for certain forms of personalisation that are relevant for the YouTube CPS and may involve profiling: i) Personalised Ads and ii) YouTube History. Users are asked to make a choice about Personalised Ads and YouTube History settings during the Google account creation process.

Account Creation Process

Users are asked if they would like to consent to the forms of personalisation controlled by these settings during the account creation process. Google offers two paths during account creation, an "Express" path that allows the user to make choices about multiple settings in a single step, and a "Manual" path that allows users to make a choice about each setting on a different screen. Users are able to go back to prior screens and switch between these paths during the account creation process. In both paths, users

are presented with information about: (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

During the “Express” and “Manual” paths, users are informed that they can change their settings and withdraw their consent by visiting account.google.com after they have created their account. Users who visit these controls are able to toggle these settings on or off and delete data subject to the YouTube History setting at any time.

A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the YouTube History setting by turning the setting off and deleting data that has been previously saved to the user’s account pursuant to the setting. Users also have the option to turn the setting off without deleting saved data, which will stop new activity data from being saved to their account pursuant to the setting, but not withdraw consent for personalisation based on existing saved data. A user may withdraw consent for the forms of personalisation controlled by the Personalised Ads setting by turning the setting off at any time.

Users who want to turn these settings on after account creation are presented with the same substantive information that is presented during account creation about (i) the type of data to be processed; (ii) how that data would be used; and (iii) how the user can manage that data processing.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation or personalised features that are controlled by these consents. A user who has set their YouTube History setting to off will also not have certain data about their activity saved to their account while the setting is off.

II. Signed-Out Users

Initial Request for Consent

Signed-out users who arrive at the YouTube CPS’s web surfaces in the EEA are presented with a banner asking if they would like to consent to the use of cookies and data for the purposes of showing a personalised user experience and showing personalised ads, among other purposes. Users have the option to click equally weighted “Accept all,” “Reject all,” or “More options” buttons. A user who selects “More options” is presented with equally weighted “off” and “on” options to (i) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise a user’s experience or (ii) consent to the use of cookies and data to personalise ads. A user can then confirm their consent choices or reject the use of cookies and data for all purposes requiring consent by choosing to “Reject all.”

Settings

Signed-out users can change their consent choices described above by visiting g.co/privacytools.

Consequences of Refusing or Withdrawing Consent

A user who refuses or withdraws the consents described above will not receive the forms of personalisation or personalised features controlled by these consents.

i) How we seek user consent through third parties

Google requires third parties who use ads services to ensure user consent is obtained for the use of cookies or other local storage where legally required and for the collection, sharing, and use of personal data with Google for ads personalisation purposes. Third parties that must ensure user consent is obtained include publishers, advertisers, data management platforms and third party exchanges.

Means by which a third party may collect user consent

Third parties must use a valid means to obtain user consent and may use an in-house solution or a Consent Management Platform. In any event, the solution used must comply with local regulations and Google's policies including our [Consent Policy](#) for the EU. To support our customers, we provide [guidance](#) on how to comply with this policy and how Google validates compliance.

How a user can withdraw consent

Users must be able to revoke their consent through the consent flows provided by third parties. Our Consent Policy for the EU requires that users are informed about how they can do so. At a minimum, users must be able to easily reach their consent settings on the respective site or app.

j) How we ensure your rights and freedoms

Google requires all product teams to assess the extent to which personal data will be processed as part of or in connection with a product prior to its launch. In addition, if a launch is flagged as potentially higher risk, a more rigorous review is required. In these situations, where the proposed processing activity potentially creates higher risks, we conduct a data protection impact assessment.

k) Automated decision making

The YouTube CPS's profiling does not involve automated decision-making within the meaning of Art. 22 GDPR.

l) Alternatives to profiling

There is a wide range of potential alternatives which may be considered at various levels and stages during the product design process. However, such potential alternatives may be more intrusive and/or less helpful than as profiling techniques, may require users to provide more (personal) information or may otherwise not work. Examples for such potential alternatives are provided below:

- **Age Assurance:** For age assurance, profiling allows us to infer the user's age in a minimally intrusive manner. As an alternative, users could be asked to provide and prove their age with

legal documentation, which would have to be verified, and users verified as adults would have to remain signed-in at all times to benefit from all of Google's services. While some users may prove their age for instance with government IDs, this alternative is generally not preferred as not all users have access to government issued identification or would wish to provide it.

- **Fraud and abuse:** For the detection of fraud and abuse in the context of advertisements, advertisers could rely on their own human review instead of profiling by Google. This would risk detecting less invalid activity or bad actors, as it would leave fraud and abuse detection up to varying levels of technology and capabilities of individual advertisers and potentially other third party companies. The scale, speed, and diversity of attempts to attack and abuse our advertising network require sophisticated automated detection and significant expertise to keep a safe advertising environment for users and prevent attempts to defraud advertisers through various types of invalid activity. Also, effective fraud and abuse detection outsourced to third parties would very likely involve similar profiling techniques as the ones used by Google. The use of these third parties, with varying degrees of capabilities and expertise, would impose unnecessary financial burden on advertisers, while increasing the potential for fragmentation in the approach, classification, and mitigation of invalid activity.